

Product Teardown: Subspace.money

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Role: Product Intern Assignment – Vocallabs.ai / Subspace.money

Introduction

I evaluated Subspace.money as a first-time user across its web platform. The goal was to understand the product from a customer's perspective and identify opportunities to improve user activation, conversion, retention, and overall product clarity.

During the evaluation, I explored:

1. Explore marketplace
2. Shared subscriptions
3. Authentication flow
4. Home dashboard
5. Wallet experience
6. Chat feature
7. Cart and payment flow
8. Profile and account settings

The analysis below focuses on real observations gathered while using the platform.

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

- Wide catalog of subscriptions and gift cards
- Attractive discounts across multiple brands
- Shared subscription model reduces user costs
- Integrated wallet ecosystem
- Strong marketplace approach with multiple categories

Weaknesses

- Product positioning is unclear for first-time users
- Feature overload without onboarding
- Wallet-based payments introduce additional friction
- Social/chat functionality lacks context

Opportunities

- Better onboarding experience
- Subscription management automation
- Personalized recommendations
- Student and family-focused acquisition campaigns

Product Feedbacks

Feedback 1: Unclear Product Positioning

Observed

Upon landing on the Explore page, I immediately saw gift cards, subscription discounts, shared subscriptions, wallet features, chat functionality, bill payments, events, and product selling capabilities.

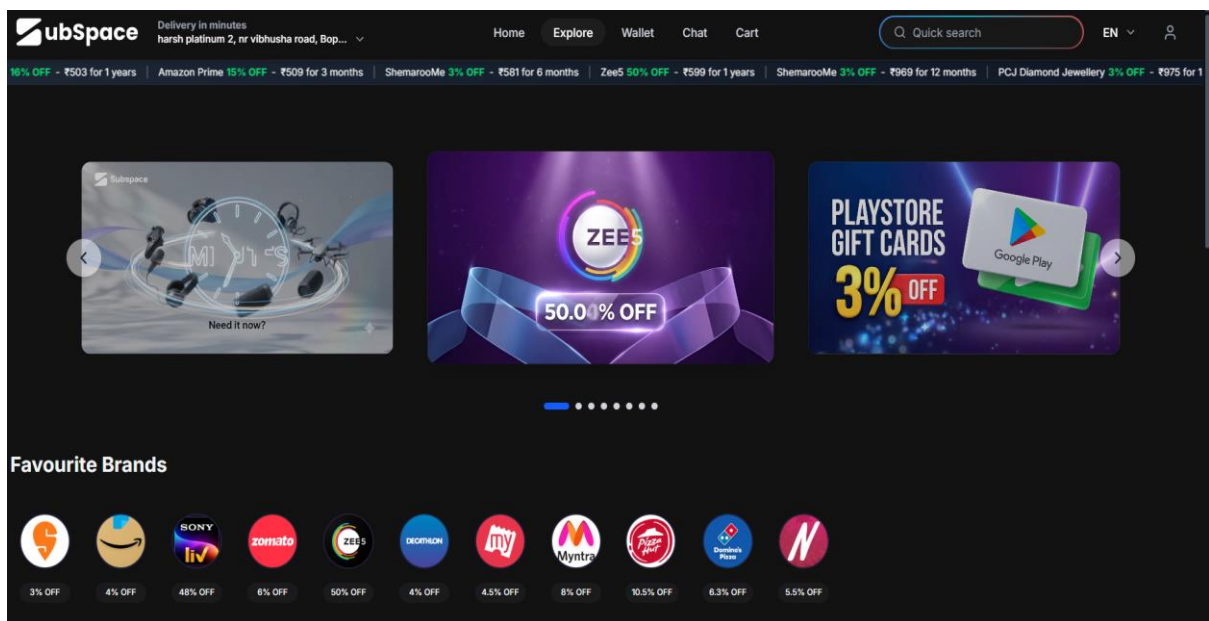


Figure 1: (First-time user landing experience showing multiple product categories and offerings)

Problem

As a first-time user, it was difficult to understand what Subspace primarily does.

The platform appears to be:

- A subscription marketplace
- A wallet app
- A messaging platform
- A bill payment platform
- A gifting platform

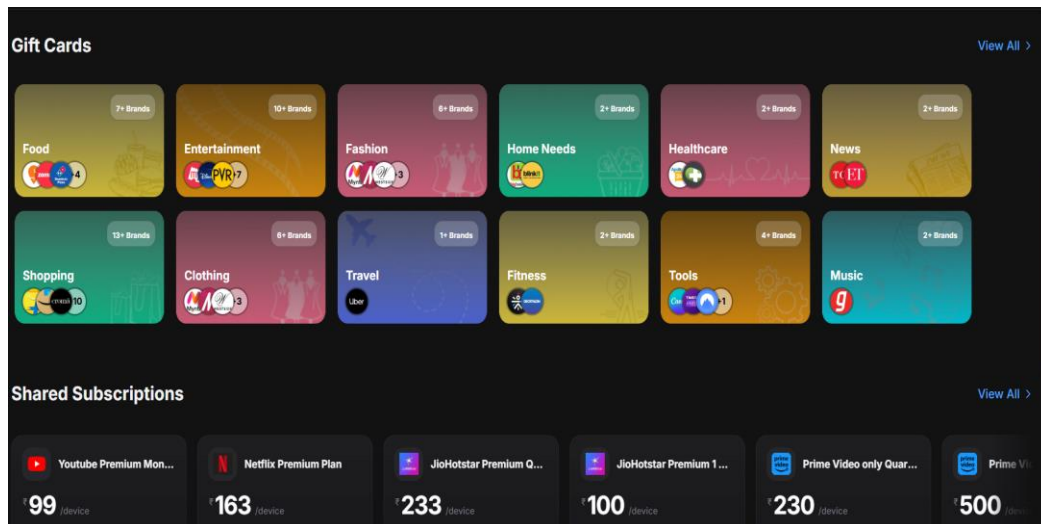


Figure 2:(Explore page displaying gift cards, category browsing, and shared subscription offerings simultaneously)

Ship Instead

Introduce a clear onboarding value proposition at the top of the platform:

"Save money on subscriptions, share plans with others, and manage recurring payments in one place."

Add a simple 3-step explanation showing:

1. Discover subscriptions
2. Join or purchase
3. Save money

Expected Impact

- Higher activation rates
- Better first-session understanding
- Improved conversion from visitors to registered users

Feedback 2: Wallet-Based Checkout Creates Conversion Friction

Observed

When purchasing a gift card, the checkout flow required adding money to the wallet before completing the purchase.

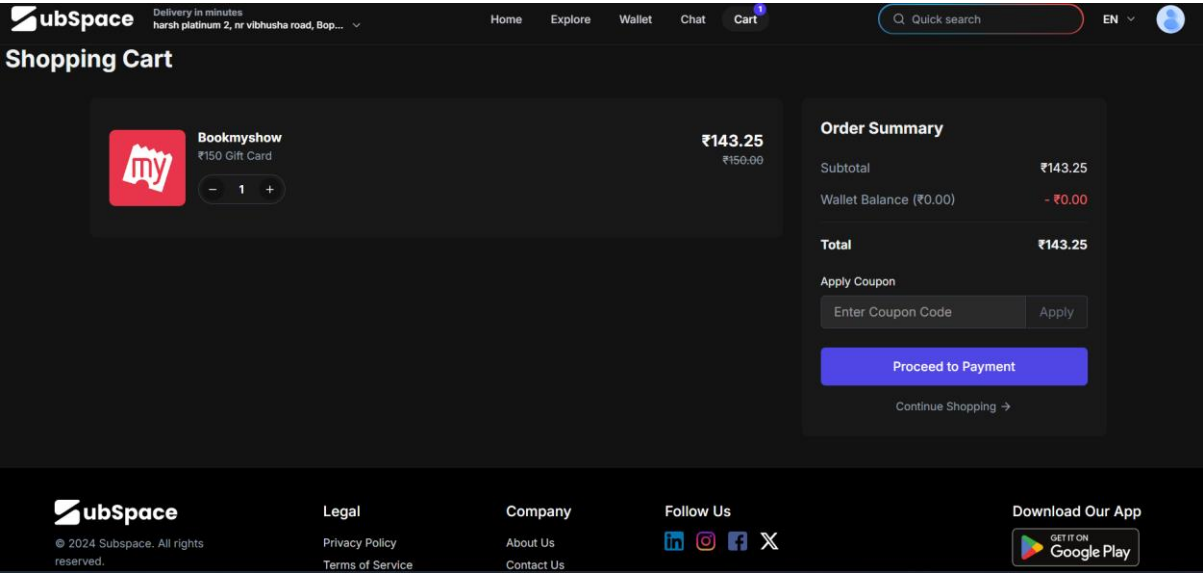


Figure 3: (Shopping cart showing gift card purchase before payment)

User journey:

Cart → Wallet Funding → Wallet Balance → Purchase

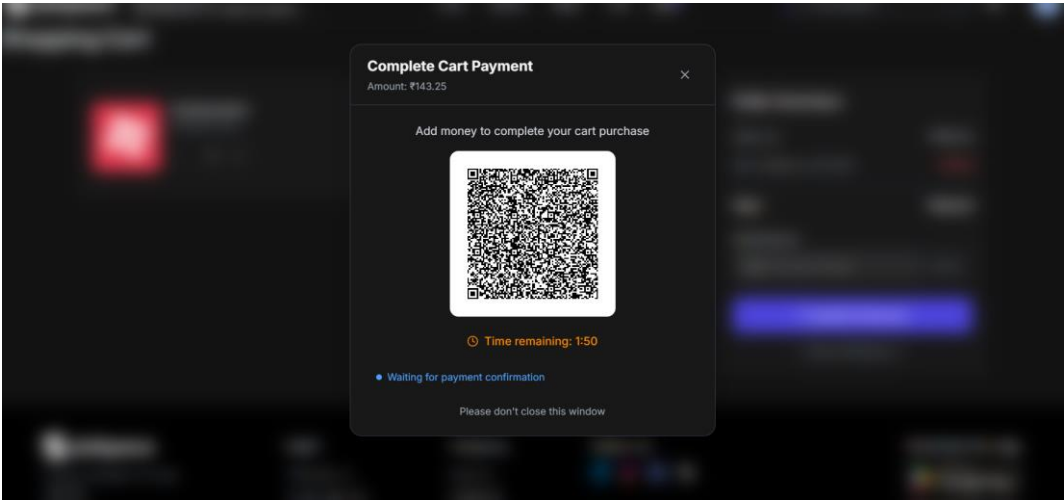


Figure 4: Wallet funding step requiring payment before purchase completion.

instead of:

Cart → Payment Gateway → Purchase Complete

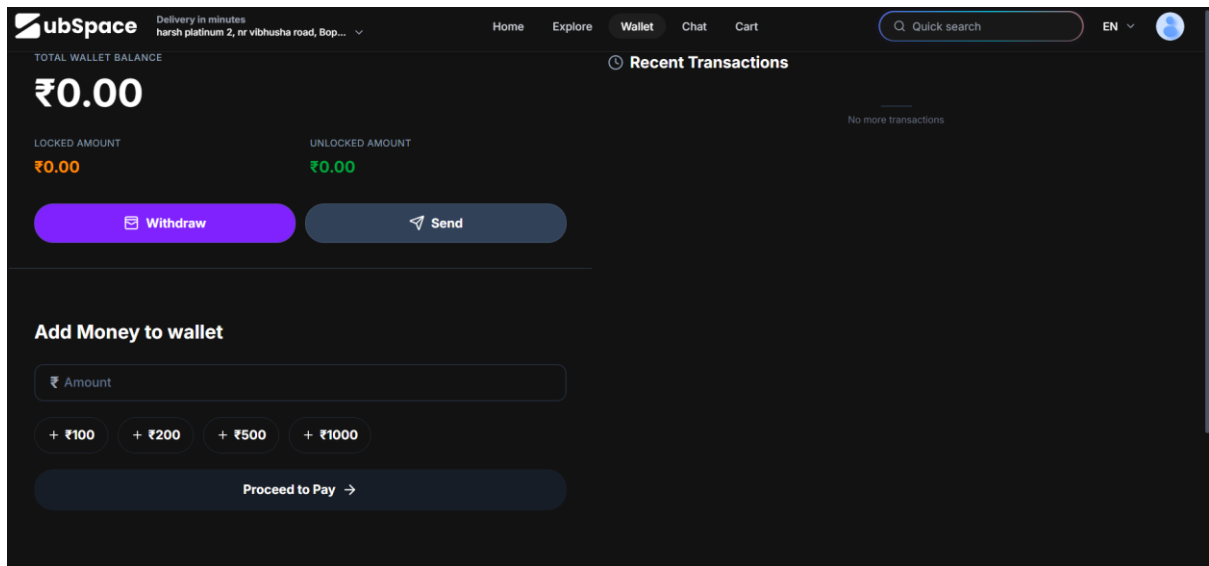


Figure 5: (Wallet interface where users must first add funds before purchasing.)

Problem

Each additional step introduces friction and increases abandonment risk.

Users purchasing a small-value item may not want to preload money into a wallet before making a transaction.

Ship Instead

Offer direct payment options:

- UPI
- Cards
- Net Banking

while keeping the wallet as an optional faster-payment method.

Expected Impact

- Reduced checkout abandonment
- Higher purchase conversion
- Faster transaction completion

Feedback 3: Chat Feature Has Weak Context

Observed

The Chat section opens a messaging interface, but there is little explanation regarding its purpose.

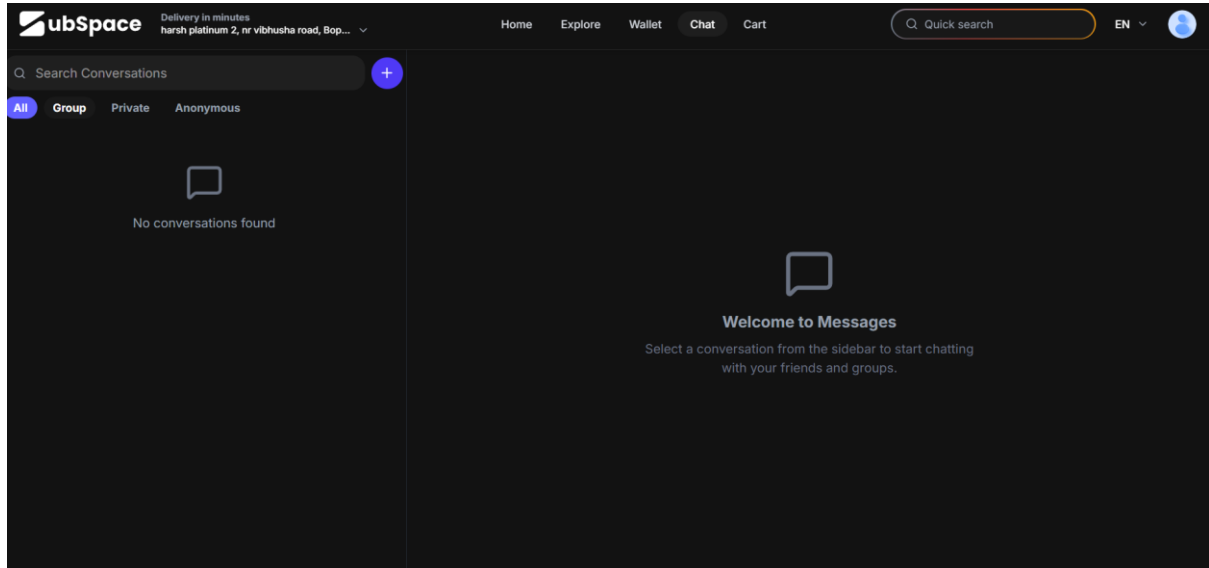


Figure 6: (Chat interface displayed to a first-time user without contextual guidance.)

As a new user, I could not immediately understand:

- Why I should use chat
- What value chat provides
- How chat supports subscriptions

Problem

Features without clear value often experience low adoption.

Users may perceive chat as unnecessary or disconnected from the platform's primary use case.

Ship Instead

Tie chat directly to subscription sharing and group purchases.

Examples:

- Create subscription-sharing groups
- Coordinate family plans
- Discuss available slots in shared subscriptions

Add onboarding copy explaining these use cases.

Expected Impact

- Increased engagement
- Better understanding of platform network effects

- Higher group-subscription adoption

Feedback 4: Empty States Miss an Opportunity to Educate Users

Problem

Empty states are critical moments in the user journey.

Instead of helping users understand the next action, the platform simply indicates that nothing exists yet.

Ship Instead

Convert empty states into educational moments.

Examples:

No Active Subscriptions:

"Browse popular subscriptions and start saving today."

No Conversations:

"Create a subscription-sharing group with friends."

No Transactions:

"Make your first purchase to unlock rewards."

Feedback 5: Profile Completion Opportunity Is Being Missed

Observed

The profile section displayed incomplete information such as:

- Username not set
- Email not set

There was no indication that completing the profile provided value.

Problem

Users have little motivation to complete account information.

Incomplete profiles reduce personalization opportunities and may affect trust and communication.

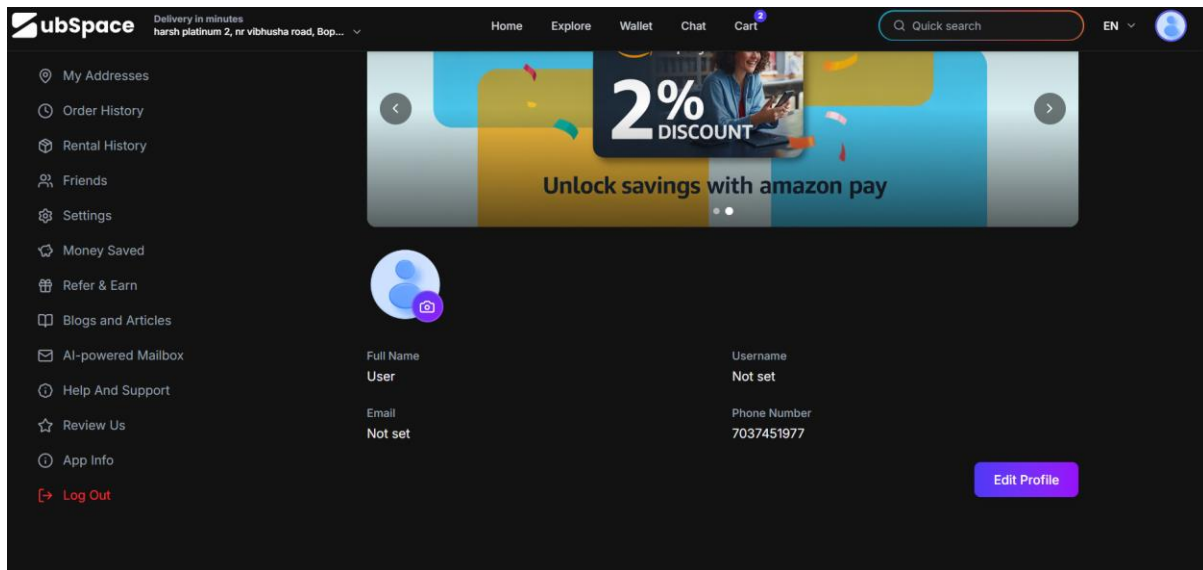


Figure 7: (User KYC page)

Ship Instead

Introduce a profile completion system.

Example:

Profile Completion: 40%

Benefits:

- ❖ Faster support
- ❖ Better recommendations
- ❖ Exclusive rewards

Offer small incentives for completion.

Expected Impact

- Better user data quality
- Increased engagement
- Improved personalization

5. Competitor Analysis

Splitwise

Strength:

Clear value proposition focused on expense sharing.

Subspace Opportunity:

Integrate subscription-sharing experiences with expense tracking.

Rocket Money

Strength:

Strong subscription visibility and management.

Subspace Opportunity:

Introduce automated subscription tracking and spending insights.

Amazon Pay

Strength:

Seamless checkout experience.

Subspace Opportunity:

Reduce payment friction and enable direct payments.

6. Conclusion

Subspace.money has built an interesting ecosystem around subscriptions, gift cards, sharing, and digital payments. The strongest opportunity lies not in adding new features but in improving clarity, activation, and conversion.

The highest-impact improvements would be:

1. Clarifying the product value proposition
2. Simplifying checkout
3. Making social features more contextual
4. Improving empty-state guidance
5. Increasing profile completion and personalization

These changes could significantly improve user understanding, conversion rates, and long-term engagement while strengthening the platform's existing marketplace model.

My final verdict

I was so impressed by the design but of course there were a little flaws when i went to check every single feature I found out there was an recharge option which wasn't working at all or maybe I don't get it as a first time user how to use it.

After that there was a bidding option but as a new user, I had no idea how it worked so even if a new user gets a little information about that section, it'll be helpful.

Like when I will open that section a pop appears and tells every single aspect about it and how it should work.

Same thing goes for the sell section and add a subscription method.

I felt that giving straight a money option because everyone uses UPI more often so why not keep the credit card and UPI payment option mainstream and wallets too for ease and benefit purposes.